MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

DevOps / Cloud Infrastructure | CI/CD & Test Infrastructure

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, including hands-on ownership of CI/CD pipelines and test infrastructure for three product teams. Builds GitLab CI workflows and Helm-based ephemeral environments on a shared Kubernetes cluster, and has reduced pipeline runtime and test flakiness through practical automation and analysis. Personal infrastructure experience includes a k3s homelab with GitOps and monitoring, plus Terraform provisioning for a Hetzner VPS. Transitioning from QA automation into DevOps and platform engineering, with hands-on experience owning CI/CD pipelines, Kubernetes-based test environments, infrastructure monitoring, and automation for three product teams.

CORE SKILLS

Infrastructure & CI/CD: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Kubernetes (namespace-level experience), Terraform (personal Hetzner VPS project), Argo CD, Ansible (basic)

Systems, networking & monitoring: Linux, PostgreSQL, Grafana, Prometheus, Loki, Traefik ingress, cert-manager, TLS certificate management

Programming & automation: Python, Bash, Java (test code), SQL

Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman

Cloud learning: AWS: EC2 and S3 basics through free-tier learning

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw *2021–Present*

- Own and operate GitLab CI workflows for three product teams (25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end testing, and artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline runtime from 38 to 14 minutes by profiling workflows, parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end testing; monthly CI runner cost decreased by approximately 30%.
- Designed and implemented per-merge-request test environments using Docker Compose and Helm on the company's shared Kubernetes cluster, with application, PostgreSQL and seeded-data deployment plus automatic cleanup after merge or 48 hours of inactivity. QA and product colleagues use the environments to review features and run end-to-end tests.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky-test rate from 7% to under 1%.
- Developed Bash and Python tooling for PostgreSQL test-data seeding. Collected CI test results in PostgreSQL and created Grafana dashboards to help teams identify flaky tests.
- Wrote the internal guide to how the CI system works, now used for onboarding, and mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw *2019–2021*

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects through manual and automated testing.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs to run nightly regression tests.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House *2018–2019*

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases, and reproduced bugs for developers.

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal *2024–2025*

- Built a three-node k3s cluster on Raspberry Pi 5 devices and deployed applications from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for monitoring, Traefik ingress, and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS with Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

EDUCATION

BEng, Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology *2018*

CERTIFICATION & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) — exam scheduled January 2027; not yet certified.

LANGUAGES

Polish (native) | English (C1) | German (A2)